

**David Michael Kretz**  
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**Academic Employment & Education**

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|---------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025-27 | Yale University                 | Postdoctoral Associate, Humanities Program.               |
| 2025    | University of Chicago           | Ph.D., Committee on Social Thought<br>& Germanic Studies. |
| 2018    | École Normale Supérieure, Paris | M.A., Philosophy.                                         |
| 2016    | Bard College Berlin             | B.A., Philosophy, literature,<br>intellectual history.    |

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**Fellowships & Affiliations**

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|---------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026-8  | Affiliated Researcher       | Hope & Crisis Lab, Institute for Advanced<br>Studies in Culture, University of Virginia |
| 2026-7  | Fellow                      | Whitney Humanities Center, Yale.                                                        |
| 2023    | Visiting Research Fellow    | École Normale Supérieure, Paris.                                                        |
| 2022    | Digital Teaching Fellow     | Brandeis University, Osher Institute.                                                   |
| 2015    | Erasmus Exchange Fellowship | Sciences Po, Paris.                                                                     |
| 2010-12 | Studies in philosophy       | University of Vienna.                                                                   |

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**Grants**

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|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| 2023    | John U. Nef Summer Travel Grant.<br><i>University of Chicago.</i>                                         | \$1000. |
| 2022    | John U. Nef Summer Travel Grant.<br><i>University of Chicago.</i>                                         | \$1600. |
| 2021    | For graduate conference organized at UChicago.<br><i>Graduate Council,</i>                                | \$900.  |
|         | <i>Committee on Social Thought,</i>                                                                       | \$400.  |
| 2019    | For international conference organized at UChicago.<br><i>Graduate Council,</i>                           | \$1500. |
|         | <i>Committee on Social Thought,</i>                                                                       | \$1500. |
|         | <i>Franke Institute for the Humanities,</i>                                                               | \$1360. |
|         | <i>Department of Germanic Studies,</i>                                                                    | \$750.  |
| 2016    | Julie J. Kidd Travel and Research Fellowship.<br><i>European Consortium of Liberal Arts and Sciences.</i> | \$1000. |
| 2016    | Transregional Center for Democratic Studies Summer Grant.<br><i>New School for Social Research.</i>       | \$1000. |
| 2014-15 | Study Exchange Scholarship for Sciences Po, Paris.<br><i>Erasmus Program of the European Union.</i>       | \$5400. |
| 2012-15 | BCB Student Conference Support Fund (four times).<br><i>Bard College Berlin.</i>                          | \$2000. |
| 2012    | Post Foundation Scholarship of 1742.<br><i>Bremer Post-Stiftung.</i>                                      | \$750.  |

## Publications

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### Book-length

*Hegel and MacIntyre: Reason in History*. Edited with C. Bernacchio, A. Fattah, M. Lazarus.  
London: Routledge, forthcoming September, 2026.

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### Book-chapters & Articles

- “Introduction” in *Hegel and MacIntyre: Reason in History*, ed. Kretz, Bernacchio, et al. London: Routledge, 2026.
- “How to Theorize Translation from Its Practice, For Example, in Germany, 1750-1830” invited contribution for a special issue of the *Yearbook of Translational Hermeneutics*, 2026.
- “Translation as a Category of Political Theory. Response to Étienne Balibar’s Mark Sachs Lecture” in *Meeting Balibar: A Discussion on Equaliberty and Differences*, ed. Soraya Nour Sckell. Lisbon, Edições Húmus, 2023.
- “Rortys *Kontingenz, Ironie und Solidarität*” in *Rorty-Handbuch*. Ed. Martin Müller. Berlin: Springer, 2022.
- “Rortys *Essays on Heidegger and Others*” in *Rorty-Handbuch*. Ed. Martin Müller. Berlin: Springer, 2022.
- “Progressive Education under Financial Pressure: The Case of Germany,” with D. Kontowski in *The University as a Critical institution?* Ed. R. Deem & H. Eggins. Rotterdam: Sense Publishers, 2017.
- “Thinkeries, Ancient and Modern: Democracy’s Challenges to Liberal Arts Education” with E. Atanassow, in *Back to the Core: Rethinking Core Texts in Liberal Arts and Science Education in Europe*. Ed. E. Cohen de Lara & H. Drop. Wilmington: Vernon Press, 2017.

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### Review Essays & Book Reviews

- “Rilke’s Parentheses” in *The German Quarterly*, 99.2. 2026.
- “Recognition for Good Europeans. On Axel Honneth’s *Recognition*, with a response by the author.” *International Journal for History, Culture and Modernity*, Vol. 9/1-4. 2022.
- “Community and Loyalty in American Philosophy: Royce, Sellars, Rorty” by Steven A. Miller. *Pragmata*, Vol. 2, 2019.
- “Ethics in the Conflicts of Modernity” by Alasdair MacIntyre, with Grégory Lenne. *Raisons Politiques*, 69/1. 2018.
- “Corporatism and Fascism,” ed. Antonio Costa Pinto. *Politics, Religion, and Ideology*. 2017.
- “Ironic Life” by Richard Bernstein. *Kronos Quarterly*, Vol. 5. 2017.

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### Translations

- Theodor W. Adorno, Seminar on W. Benjamin’s *The Origin of German Tragic Drama* (1932).  
Ger.–Fr. with Jean Tain. *Revue Philosophie*, no. 160. Éditions de Minuit: Paris, Jan. 2024.
- Angela Sanmann. “‘The Exercise of a Just Love of Humanity’: Sophie von La Roche as Female Cosmopolitan.” Ger.–Engl., with Lindsay Parkhowell. *Women’s Writing*, 2020.
- Max Spielman and Sotirios Bahtsetzis, “Post-Industrial Design – Our Standpoint.”  
Ger.–Engl., with Lindsay Parkhowell. Institut Hyperwerk, 2016.
- Stefan Zweig, “To Friends in Foreign Land.”  
Ger.–Engl. In *Asymptote Journal*. Oct 2016.

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|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|
| <b>Teaching</b>         |                                                        |            |        |
| Instructor<br>of record | German 101, 102, 103                                   | U Chicago  | '19-20 |
|                         | Philosophy of History (in German)                      | U Chicago  | 2022   |
|                         | Rilke's <i>Duino Elegies &amp; Sonnets to Orpheus</i>  | Brandeis U | 2022   |
|                         | Goethe's <i>Faust</i>                                  | Brandeis U | 2022   |
|                         | Franz Rosenzweig's <i>Hegel and the State</i>          | 36LM       | 2025   |
| Teaching<br>Assistant   | Ancient Historical & Political Thought                 | Yale U     | 2025   |
|                         | Thomas Mann's <i>Magic Mountain</i> (David Wellbery)   | U Chicago  | 2020   |
|                         | Hegel's <i>Phenomenology of Spirit</i> (Robert Pippin) | U Chicago  | 2022   |
|                         | 'Backwards' Course Design (Avi Bernstein)              | Brandeis U | 2022   |

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### Selection of Conference Talks & Invited Lectures

- 11/26 "Sacralized Sovereignty as a Problem for Democratic Mourning"  
*Social Science History Association*. Atlanta, GA.
- 09/26 "What Translation Studies can do for Critical Theory"  
Whitney Humanities Center, Yale University.
- 05/26 "Kant's Silent Dialogue with Robespierre on Religion, Law, Morality"  
*The French Revolution and the Sacred*. Sciences Po, Paris.
- 05/26 "The Concept of Modernity: A Phenomenological Approach"  
*International Network for the Theory of History*. Tallin, Estonia.
- 04/26 "Concepts of Translation: Why we Need Them, Where to Find Them"  
*TRANSIT Anniversary conference*, UC Berkeley.
- 02/26 "Modernity and Translational Mourning"  
Institute for Advanced Studies, U Virginia.
- 01/26 "Faust's translation, Goethe's *translatio*"  
*MLA conference*, Toronto.
- 10/25 "The Concept of Modernity: A Phenomenological Approach"  
Elm Institute, New Haven, CT.
- 03/25 "Modernity and Translational Mourning"  
*Committee on Social Thought Colloquium*, U Chicago.
- 11/24 "Translational Action as Creative Mourning"  
*De/limiting Translation*. German department, U Michigan.
- 09/24 "A Computational Analysis of German translator's prefaces, 1750-1830"  
Digital Hum. seminar, *German Studies Association*, annual conference, Atlanta.
- 01/24 "Concepts of Translation, Germany, ca. 1800."  
*Literature and Philosophy Workshop*, UChicago.
- 07/23 "Digitizing the *Messkataloge*: On Early Modern German Publishing and Translation."  
With Jeff Tharsen. *Digital Humanities 2023*. Graz, Austria.
- 06/23 "Genius as the Form of Historical Agency in Kant."  
*Kant on Intellectual Freedom*, LMU Munich.
- 03/23 "Rilkean Rigor."  
*American Comparative Literature Association*, annual conference, Chicago.
- 02/23 "Kant on the Forms of Historical Agency."

- German Philosophy Workshop*, UChicago.
- 12/22 “Rilke, Heidegger, Historical Crisis.”  
*Literature and Philosophy Workshop*, UChicago.
- 06/22 “Rilke’s Work of Mourning and the Unity of the Elegies.”  
Christoph König’s seminar. Osnabrück, Germany.
- 05/22 “The Habermas-Gadamer debate.”  
Antoine Pageau-St. Hilaire’s seminar. U Chicago.
- 06/21 “Thomas Mann: Irony & Engagement.”  
Panel with Mark Lilla, Esil Elling. Northwestern U. Online.
- 12/20 Panel with Glenn Most, Aaron Tugendhaft, Ewa Atanassow on *The Idols of ISIS*.  
Berlin/Chicago. Online.
- 11/20 “Translational Action at the End of a World.”  
*Anthropological Association of Ireland*. Online.
- 11/20 “Aristophanes’ *Clouds* & Liberal Education Today.”  
Guest lecture. Bard College Berlin. Online.
- 03/20 “A Liberal Arts Experience: from Berlin to Chicago.”  
Guest lecture. U Tyumen, Russia. Online.
- 03/20 “‘Translation’ as a Concept of Political Thought. Response to Balibar.”  
Nova Law School, Portugal. Online.
- 11/19 “Poets and Translators at the End of a World.”  
*UToronto Philosophy Grad Conference*.
- 05/19 “Rorty’s *Contingency, Irony, and Solidarity* as Bildungsroman.”  
*Rorty-Tagung*, Tübingen, Germany.
- 02/19 “Troeltsch and/or/against Gadamer.”  
*UNotre Dame & UChicago Graduate Conference*, UChicago.
- 06/18 “Translational Action for a Pragmatist Enlightenment.”  
*3rd European Pragmatism Conference*. Helsinki U.
- 09/16 “Translational Action at the End of a World.”  
*Conceptual Change in History*. Helsinki U.
- 09/16 “Progressive Education Under Financial Pressure – The Liberal Arts in Germany.”  
*29th Consortium on Higher Ed Research Conference*. Cambridge U.
- 05/16 “Translational Action at the End of a World.”  
*10th Annual Conference of the International Society for MacIntyrean Enquiry*.  
Wrocław U.
- 09/15 “Thinkeries, Ancient and Modern: Aristophanic Challenges to Liberal Arts  
Education” with Prof. Ewa Atanassow.  
*Liberal Arts and Sciences Education and Core Texts in the European Context*.  
Amsterdam University College.
- 01/14 “Against Moral Eliminativism.”  
*6th Conference of the Dutch Flemish Association for Analytic Philosophy*.  
U Groningen, Netherlands.

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### Conferences Organized

- 10/22 *Hegel and MacIntyre. A Philosophy Conference on Reason in History.*  
With Caleb Bernacchio, Ahmed Fattah, and Michael Lazarus. Online.  
Featuring: Rahel Jaeggi, Jennifer Herdt, Robert Pippin & others.
- 05/21 *Heidegger: Politics, History, Modernity. An International Grad Student Conference.*  
With Mat Messerschmidt & Antoine Pageau St. Hilaire. Online.  
Keynotes: Judith Wolfe & Ryan Coyne.
- 04/19 One-day workshop on Geoff Lehman's & Michael Weinman,  
*Plato, the Parthenon, and Liberal Education.*  
Co-organizers: Ena M. Gojak and Xinyue Zhang. University of Chicago.
- 05/14 „Pioneering 15 Years of Liberal Education in Germany.”  
Panel presenting research on the history of ECLA/ BCB.  
With Lucian Cosinschi, Aya Ibrahim, Irina Stelea, Michael Weinman.  
Bard College Berlin.

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### Lecture Series & Academic Events Organized

- 2023-24 *Committee on Social Thought colloquium.* Coordinated with Xinyue Zhang. UChicago.
- 2020-21 *Literature and Philosophy Workshop.* Coordinated with Xinyue Zhang. Online.
- 01/21 Guest lecture by Hannes Bajohr at UChicago, *Poetry and Poetics Workshop.* Online.
- 05/19 American premiere of *Hans Blumenberg—Der unsichtbare Philosoph*,  
with talks by Robert Pippin and David Wellbery. U Chicago.
- 2015 Two guest lectures by Adrian Piper. Initiated & organized. Bard College Berlin.
- 2015 Guest lecture by Norman Manea. Organized, moderated. Bard College Berlin.

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### Selection of Masterclasses & Summer Programs

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|-------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 07/26 | Humboldt University               | Forces of History. R. Jaeggi, D. Chakrabarty, A. Battistoni.                                               |
| 10/24 | University of Chicago             | Miguel Abensour on utopia. <i>Martin Breugh &amp; Paul Mazzocchi.</i>                                      |
| 10/24 | University of Chicago             | Theory of religion after Hegel & Nietzsche. <i>Hans Joas.</i>                                              |
| 08/23 | UBC & Kuaijishan Acad.            | Buddhist philosophy. <i>K. Crosby, R. Sharf, B. ter Haar.</i>                                              |
| 09/23 | University of Chicago             | What comes after the secularization thesis? <i>Hans Joas</i>                                               |
| 06/22 | Sorbonne I, Paris.                | Mourning, melancholia, politics. <i>A. Ricciardi &amp; I. Alfandary.</i>                                   |
| 11/21 | University of Chicago             | Computational text-analysis. <i>Brooke Luetgert.</i>                                                       |
| 08/21 | Fondation Rilke                   | Rilke's Duino Elegies. <i>Christoph König.</i>                                                             |
| 07/19 | University of Bonn                | Hermeneutics. <i>Michael Forster &amp; Markus Gabriel.</i>                                                 |
| 07/18 | UChicago Centre Paris             | Levinas' political philosophy. <i>Richard A. Cohen.</i>                                                    |
| 07/17 | University of Tübingen            | Political ecology. <i>Bruno Latour.</i>                                                                    |
| 03/17 | Catholic Academy Bavaria          | Pragmatism. <i>Richard J. Bernstein.</i>                                                                   |
| 02/17 | University of Tübingen            | Phenomenology and the Myth of the Given. <i>Ray Brassier.</i>                                              |
| 07/16 | New School for<br>Social Research | Social epistemology. <i>Alice Cray.</i><br>Memory, trauma, history. <i>Carol and Richard J. Bernstein.</i> |
| 05/16 | Princeton & Humboldt U.           | The state of exception. <i>Jan-Werner Müller.</i>                                                          |
| 07/15 | Viadrina European U.              | Rule of law: Kant, Hegel, Habermas. <i>G. Lohmann, R. Adolphi.</i>                                         |
| 03/13 | Bard College Berlin               | Poetry Translation. <i>Peter Filkins.</i>                                                                  |

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## Languages

German (native), English (near native), French (fluent), Latin & Ancient Greek (reading), Mandarin Chinese (beginner).

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## Service to Institution and Profession

- 2022-23 Initiated “Committee on the Committee,”  
to gather student input on strategic directions for the  
Committee on Social Thought in a moment of institutional transition.
- 2021 Book reviewer for Emerald Publishing.
- 2019-24 Graduate Student Union steward for the German Department.
- 2019-20 Representative to Dean’s Student Advisory Board.
- 2016-17 Student Representative for philosophy M.A. students at ENS.
- 2014-16 Co-initiated the BCB History Taskforce.  
Following the name change from European College of Liberal Arts  
to Bard College Berlin,  
it brought together students, faculty, staff, alumni and:
- conducted 50+ hours of oral history research interviews,
  - curated an on-campus museum,
  - researched and re-opened the institutional archives,
  - improved online presentation of the college’s history.
- 2012-16 Student representative to the BCB Academic Senate (‘13-16),  
Member of the Studies Committee (‘12/13),  
Student Life Committee (*ex officio*, ‘13/14).
- 2014-15 External Reviewer for international undergraduate philosophy journal *Stance*.  
([stance.iweb.bsu.edu](http://stance.iweb.bsu.edu))

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## Public-Facing Writing

- 2019-23 Poetry Staff, *Chicago Review*
- 2019-22 Contributing Editor, *Journal of the History of Ideas Blog*

Various contributions to public-facing venues like *The Point Magazine*, *Libération*, *Journal of the History of Ideas Blog*, *Public Seminar*, *Tocqueville21*, *Die Bärliner*, and *Opium Philosophie*.

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## Relevant Work Experience

- 2016-18 Freelance translator (e.g., for Institute HyperWerk, [versus.com](http://versus.com)). Part-time.
- 2017 Gakko Project ([gakko.org](http://gakko.org)). Instructor at international summer camps.  
Romania and Indonesia. Teaching philosophy & poetry translation.
- 2015-16 Program Assistant to BCB German language & culture study-abroad programs.
- 2011 Diakonie ‘Eine Welt’ ([einewelt.diakonie.at](http://einewelt.diakonie.at)). In lieu of military service,  
administrative & translation work at pro-bono legal counseling center for  
refugees. Full-time.

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## References

Prof. Florian Klinger,  
Associate Professor,  
Germanic Studies & the College,  
University of Chicago,  
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Prof. Timothy Harrison,  
Associate Professor,  
English, Committee on Social Thought, Divinity,  
University of Chicago,  
[harrisont@uchicago.edu](mailto:harrisont@uchicago.edu)

Prof. Haun Saussy,  
University Professor,  
Committee on Social Thought &  
East Asian Languages and Civilizations,  
University of Chicago,  
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Dr. Michael Weinman,  
Senior Lecturer,  
Political Science & Jewish Studies,  
University of Indiana, Bloomington,  
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### *Teaching Reference:*

Dr. Maeve Hooper,  
Director of the German Language Program,  
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[hooperm@uchicago.edu](mailto:hooperm@uchicago.edu)